

PERSONAL

I am an eager and creative data scientist from the Netherlands. Currently, I pursue my PhD in political communication, where I focus on the strategic and mediated use of multimodal information in the digital age.

INFO

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WIES RUYTERS



04 / 03 / 1998

LANGUAGES

dutch mother tongue
english fluent
spanish advanced
italian beginner

SKILLS

python advanced
html/css beginner
adobe intermediate
powerpoint advanced

INTERESTS

culture and learning languages
sports running, road cycling, CrossFit, yoga
nature hiking, camping
hobby recreational vegetarian chef
art poetry writer, visualizer of technical stuff, concert visitor

EDUCATION

MSc Data Science in Engineering, TU/e

Thesis: "Behind the Political Frame: Exploring Visualization Methods to Increase Bias Awareness and Mitigate Framing Effects on Social Media" (9.0/10)

GPA: 8.3 (Cum Laude)

Minor: Department of Digital Humanities, University of Bologna (9.8/10)

BSc Industrial Engineering, TU/e

Thesis: "Enhancing Sustainable Travel Behavior Through Redesigning Information Sharing" (8/10)

GPA: 7.2

EXPERIENCE

PhD candidate From September 2023, Wageningen University and Research

Project: VICI - The mobilization of political dissatisfaction: causes, content, consequences

Data Analyst 2022, BusinessDev Holland

Project: Exploratory cost development analysis of heatpumps in The Netherlands

Central Introduction Committee 2021, TU/e

Student Assistant 2018 - 2022, TU/e

Positions: Teacher Support, Information Team

EXTRACURRICULAR

EXPEDITIE NEXT, editions 2025 (Roermond), 2026 (Enkhuizen)

Responsibility: Creator and host of an extracurricular activity for primary school pupils from all across the country.

Topic: Pupils were to design their "ideal prime minister" through coloring pages. The activity aimed to provoke reflections on political representation among youth.

Workshop host, 2024 - current

Responsibility: Freelance workshop-host for schools and institutions

Topic: Societal polarization and political communication

WASS PhD Council, 2024 - current
Wageningen University and Research

Social Volunteer, 2023 - 2026
City of Utrecht, The Netherlands

Foundations: "Mijn Wijk Jouw Wijk", organizer of meet-and-eat evenings to connect refugees with neighborhood residents; De Tussenvoorziening, loneliness-buddy

Unleash Innovation Lab Participant 2019,
United Nations, Shengzhen, China

SDG group: Responsible Consumption and Production - Sustainable Tourism

PR and communications manager 2018,
TU/e Student Team Solid

current position

PhD candidate *From September 2023, Wageningen University and Research*

Project: VICI - The mobilization of political dissatisfaction: causes, content, consequences

Main responsibility: Studying the multi-modal representations of politicians with a data-driven approach. I work with news and social media data, which I collect myself.

publications

Wies Ruyters, Susan Vermeer & Rens Vliegenthart (forthcoming) *Modalities matter: the effect of monomodal versus multimodal news coverage on party leader recall*, [Oxford Handbook of Personality Politics](#)

Wies Ruyters, Susan Vermeer, Sanne Kruikemeier & Rens Vliegenthart (2025) *Embedding, embedding on the wall; who is the most prominent politician of them all? Exploring automated methods to study multimodal political news coverage*, [Communication Methods and Measures](#)
DOI: 10.1080/19312458.2025.2558736

conference presentations

September 2026 *ECPR general conference, Krakow (Jagiellonian University)*

Presentation 1: The Populist Gaze: A multi-modal analysis of populist framing on social versus news media

Presentation 2: Connected Conservatives: On The Transnationalization of Far Right Discourse on X

June 2026 *ICA annual conference, Cape Town (Stellenbosch University)*

Presentation: Modality matters?! How multimodal media prominence drives political recognition and party support

September 2025 *ECREA interim conference, Innsbruck (University of Innsbruck)*

Presentation: Modality matters?! How multimodal media prominence drives political recognition and party support

June 2025 *ICA pre-conference, Denver Colorado (University of Denver)*

Conference theme: *Frames of Visual Transition*

Presentation: Modality matters?! How multimodal media prominence drives political recognition and party support

April 2025 *CompTEXT conference, Vienna (University of Vienna)*

Presentation: Modality matters?! How multimodal media prominence drives political recognition and party support

February 2025 *Etmaal of communication science, Brugge (KU Leuven)*

Netherlands-Flanders Communication Association

Presentation: Beyond words: How multimodal media prominence drives political recognition and party support

May 2024 *CompTEXT conference, Amsterdam (VU Amsterdam)*

Presentation: Multi-modal news framing in the wild: an in-depth analysis of political news published by NOS.nl during the Dutch parliamentary elections of 2023.

February 2024 *Etmaal of communication science, Rotterdam (Erasmus school of history, culture, and communication)*

Presentation: Newsworthify me, positively or negatively: a multi-modal approach to examine media

poster presentation

Februari 2026 *Etmaal of communication science, Wageningen (Wageningen University and Research)*

Poster: The Populist Gaze

summer schools

July 2026 *ECPR standing group on Extremism and Democracy Summer School, Alma Mater Studiorum (University of Bologna)*

Host: European Consortium for Political Research (ECPR)

August 2024 *International Summer School of Political Communication, Università degli Studi di Milano*

Host: International Communication Association (ICA)

June 2024 *SICSS Summer Institute for Computational Social Sciences, University of Amsterdam*

Host: Amsterdam Institute for Computational Social Science Research

event moderation & public appearances

October 2025 *WASS PhD Day: Perspective on Peace*

Location: Wageningen University and Research, Omnia conference center

Responsibility: Theme design, Communications & PR, panel moderation

February 2025 *Model United Nations Amersfoort (FAMUN)*

Location: Farel College, Amersfoort

Responsibility: Keynote speaker